

Possessives: 's vs of

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Choose 's or 'of' mainly by whether the owner is a person/animal or a thing:

1 's — people, animals, groups, time (my sister's car, a week's holiday).

2 of — things and abstract nouns (the leg of the table, the start of the year).

Plural nouns ending in -s take just an apostrophe: the teachers' room. Singular nouns add 's: the boss's office.

At a glance

Use 's	Use of
People: Anna's bag	Things: the roof of the house
Animals: the dog's tail	Abstract: the end of the story
Groups: the team's win	Parts: the leg of the table
Time: today's news, a week's rest	Ideas: the cause of the problem

Learning objectives

- Can use 's for people/animals/groups and 'of' for things (CEFR A2).
- Can place apostrophes correctly with singular and plural nouns.
- Can use 's in time expressions (a day's work).



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Possessives: 's vs of · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. This is ____ car.

- A. my brother's
- B. the car of my brother
- C. my brother of
- D. my brothers

2. Please close ____ .

- A. the door of the car
- B. the car's door well
- C. the door's car
- D. the car door of

3. Have you seen ____ news?

- A. today's
- B. the news of today well
- C. today of
- D. todays

4. The ____ toys are all over the floor. (more than one child)

- A. children's
- B. childrens'
- C. childrens
- D. child's

5. That's the ____ changing room. (the players, plural)

- A. players'
- B. player's
- C. players
- D. players's

6. We can't see ____ from here.

- A. the top of the mountain
- B. the mountain's top of
- C. the top's mountain
- D. the mountain of top

7. It's ____ office. (the boss, singular)

- A. the boss's
- B. the boss'
- C. the bosses
- D. the boss of

8. After ____ rest, she felt better. (one week)

- A. a week's
- B. a week of
- C. a weeks
- D. a weeks'

9. Correct this: 'The leg of the dog is hurt.'

- A. The dog's leg is hurt.
- B. The leg's dog is hurt.
- C. The dog leg's is hurt.
- D. The legs of dog is hurt.

10. Which owner normally takes 's?

- A. A person, animal or group.
- B. A thing like a table or box.
- C. An abstract idea.
- D. A part of an object.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. my brother's** — A person takes 's': 'my brother's car'.
2. **A. the door of the car** — A thing/part takes 'of': 'the door of the car' (or 'the car door').
3. **A. today's** — Time expressions take 's': 'today's news'.
4. **A. children's** — 'Children' is an irregular plural: 'the children's toys'.
5. **A. players'** — A plural ending in -s takes just an apostrophe: 'the players' room'.
6. **A. the top of the mountain** — A part of a thing takes 'of': 'the top of the mountain'.
7. **A. the boss's** — A singular noun adds 's', even ending in -s: 'the boss's office'.
8. **A. a week's** — Time takes 's': 'a week's rest'.
9. **A. The dog's leg is hurt.** — An animal takes 's': 'the dog's leg'.
10. **A. A person, animal or group.** — People, animals and groups take 's'.